

Draw the Path: Portfolio Sitemap + Toolkit (Week 1)

Track: General AI Fluency | Phase: Setup | Author: Harshit Kudhial (@harshitttt077) | Date: September 2026

1. Strategic Alignment: The Person, The Claim, The One Action

Component	Strategic Definition & Focus
The One Person	Senior Engineering Director, Technical Founder, or ML Hiring Manager seeking engineers who bridge low-level systems (RTOS/C++), applied ML ranking, and reactive web architecture.
The Claim (Proof Statement)	'I build reliable, observable systems at the intersection of low-level performance (RTOS), applied machine learning (tabular ranking), and reactive web architecture (Next.js/GSAP).'
The One Action	Schedule a 15-minute technical deep-dive call via direct 1-click calendar embed (or email directly at harshitkudhial@gmail.com).

2. The Lean Sitemap: 4 Stages from Landing to Action

Stage / Section	Content & Observable Evidence	Why It Earns Its Place
1. Hero / Hook	- Core Proof Statement - Real-time availability telemetry - Primary CTA: [Book 15-Min Deep-Dive]	Answers 'who are you and why care?' in 4 seconds; immediate CTA for high-intent visitors.
2. The Proof (3 Flagship Systems)	1. FlyRank ML Engine: 2.8x lift, Precision@50 0.240→0.680, DuckDB 2. Zephyr RTOS Driver: Zero race conditions, hardware ISR timing 3. GeetHub Reactive Engine: Next.js App Router, strict contracts, 60fps	Replaces uncured grids with 3 verified production-grade systems backed by metrics & GitHub.
3. Mindset & Toolkit	- First-principles philosophy (kernel/math before abstractions) - Honest validation (client-holdout > in-sample fit) - Core stack: Python, C/C++, TypeScript, Next.js, DuckDB	Demonstrates how I think when things break; signals maturity and rigor over buzzwords.
4. Conversion / Action	1-Click calendar booking embed (15-min call) - Direct verified email: harshitkudhial@gmail.com - GitHub code reference: @harshitttt077	Zero friction; replaces anonymous multi-field contact forms with instant scheduling.

Deliberately Omitted (Anti-Bloat Guard): (1) No generic 'Projects Gallery' (dilutes focus with basic CRUD apps); (2) No 'Musings / Blog' (avoids half-baked filler); (3) No multi-field forms (destroys conversion).

3. Claude Project Configuration (Long-Term Tutor)

Project Name: Portfolio Build Tutor: Harshit Kudhial | **Role:** Socratic Tutor and Harsh Technical Reviewer.

Custom Instructions Excerpt: 'You are a senior engineering director and ruthless reviewer. Your sole objective is to help Harshit build a zero-fluff engineering portfolio over the next 8 weeks. Challenge weak claims, flag cognitive dissonance, spot conversion friction, and demand verifiable benchmarks (latency, Precision@K, PR links). If a proposed page does not advance the claim or the one action, order him to cut it.'

4. The Real Pressure-Test Prompt, Critique & Changes Made

Pressure-Test Prompt Submitted:

'I am building my engineering portfolio around this claim: "I build reliable, observable systems at the intersection of RTOS, ML, and reactive web." My sitemap has 5 sections: (1) Hero with particle background and 'View Work' button; (2) 3 Flagship Systems; (3) Project Archive with 12 side projects & certificates; (4) About / Mini-Blog; (5) Multi-field Contact Form. The One Action is: Schedule a 15-minute technical call. Pressure-test this against my claim and action. What creates friction? What should I kill?'

Claude's Critique (Tutor Output):

'Your sitemap is hedging its bets and working against your one action:

- Kill the Project Archive immediately:** A grid of 12 coursework projects and certificates dilutes your claim. You claim high-performance RTOS and ML systems, yet you're showing basic CRUD apps. Keep only the 3 flagship systems.
- Kill the Contact Form:** A busy founder or VP will not wait 3 days for form replies. Embed a 1-click 15-min calendar link right next to your direct email. Zero friction.
- Kill the Mini-Blog:** Move your engineering philosophy directly under your 3 flagship projects.
- Fix the Hero CTA:** 'View Work' is passive browsing. Make the technical call booking visible in the hero and footer.

Verdict: Reduce from 5 sprawling sections to 4 tight, linear stages.'

Specific Revisions Made from Critique:

- Eliminated Archive & Blog:** Constrained portfolio strictly to 3 flagship case studies and an engineering philosophy block.
- Replaced Contact Form with 1-Click Scheduling:** Integrated instant calendar booking widget + direct verified email, and changed Hero CTA to direct booking trigger.